

OREGON CITY COURIER

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THE COUNTY AGENT

Dr. E. O. Holland of the Washington State college, Pullman, Wash., says in the annual report of the Portland Union Stockyards company:

Until comparatively a few years ago, farmers of America tilled their soil, selected and planted their seed, harvested and marketed their crops, and farmed generally very much as their fathers and forefathers farmed before them. Even in the simple matter of rotation of crops, they were guided largely by custom and blind imitation.

Gradually, with the accumulation of scientific knowledge which was none the less practical by being scientific, farmers began to break away from customs and precedents.

But the change was slow. For a long time it was difficult to get the correct information to the farmer in a form that would enable him to use it. The distribution of printed matter, while of great service, fell far short of filling the need. What the farmers required was a convincing proof that new ways of producing and handling crops were superior to the ways of their fathers and forefathers. Many methods of taking the agricultural colleges and the experiment stations to the farmer on his farm were tried.

The work of the extension division of the United States government in co-operation with the various land grant colleges did a great deal to arouse interest in scientific and practical farming. But it was difficult for the lecturers to cover a large state and at the same time spend enough time with the individual groups of farmers to get them to take up the various improved methods of farming and marketing which were recommended. This was true, practically of all farmers—the thinking and the progressive ones as well as the unthinking and unprogressive. It was soon discovered that the traveling lecturer alone was not practical enough for the practical farmer.

Today, through the use of county agents, the agricultural colleges and the experiment stations are able to bring the benefits of their work to every farmer who is willing to learn. Even now, with the enrollment in the agricultural colleges mounting into thousands, there yet remains uncared for a large farming and industrial population throughout the state that must be reached—and these are the people served by the county agents. As the work and organization of the colleges becomes perfected in all the counties, it will be possible for them to enroll in their "student-body," under the direction of these agents, practically all of the farming population of the state.

Usually a county agent can employ a county agent in co-operation with the state college and the government at an expense of about one-tenth of a mill taxation. However, here in Washington the work of these county agents is so highly regarded that in one county—one of the smallest counties in the northwest—the taxpayers have volunteered to tax themselves one mill in order to have the benefits of the county agent. They believe that it pays them in dollars and cents to have such a specialist to work with them.

WAITING FOR WAR

In dismissing Ambassador Bernstorff and recalling Ambassador Gerard, President Wilson has the unqualified support of a united people, who face with equanimity as they will bear with fortitude whatever may be the consequences. While the president's action does not necessarily mean that we shall have war with Germany, only a miracle, for which we can hardly look in this age of realism, can avert war. The miracle

must be of Germany's making; she must abandon her avowed purpose of running amuck on the seas, destroying without warning or discrimination and ruthlessly the ships of neutrals and belligerents alike. As Germany appeared to have been quite deliberate in her determination to cause the president to break off diplomatic relations, we shall not expect her to forego the murderous use of the submarine, her last weapon of frightfulness, and shall merely wait until she has added to her long list of unfriendly acts against this friendly nation the unpardonable sin of slaying some more of our citizens.

If war should come, our part in it will be useful, but not glorious. We shall continue to sell to the allies—who will then be our allies—whatever they can buy; probably we shall give them a little better terms for cash and reduce the interest a little. We shall give their merchantmen the protection of our light cruisers, and, through the employment of torpedo destroyers, keep open the sea lanes of commerce that the enemy is striving so desperately to close. There will be other ways of doing our bit to bring the war to a speedy close.

But our importance as a military nation or as a factor in the war is not regarded very highly by either belligerents or neutrals. Germany undoubtedly sought to involve us in the conflict, and the European neutrals politely but firmly refused to follow our lead in breaking with the kaiser. We can take two views of this refusal: Either the neutral nations resent the president's assumption of leadership, or they fear that the kaiser is not yet so weak that he is without power to deal a smashing blow at whoever dares to elect him an enemy.

President Wilson has earnestly and sincerely—and, we sometimes thought, too complaisantly—tried to maintain peaceful relations with Germany. We shall not point now to the many reasons for offense that a proud and warlike nation could have found in Germany's course toward us. We shall still hope for peace; but if war is forced on us, we shall remember the Lusitania, as some years ago we remembered the Maine.—Spectator.

THE DAY OF THE CAR

Leading manufacturers of automobiles in this country scoff at the suggestion that the distribution of motor cars is nearing the "saturation point," meaning a let-up in the demand and a decline in the business. On the other hand, they believe the coming season will again break the record, with an even larger output than last year, despite the fact that many manufacturers have been compelled to increase their prices on account of the higher cost of materials and labor.

Last year's output of passenger cars closely approached the million mark, and it is estimated the output for the present year will considerably exceed that figure. More than a hundred factories are now engaged in this business, of which twenty-seven, including some of the largest concerns, are located at Detroit or at nearby points. Seventy-nine per cent of all the cars made in this country last year are credited to Michigan. Ohio takes second place and Indiana third.

These are conclusions derived from data recently given in a motor car publication and are supposed to be based on official returns. They serve to bring home the wonderful extent of the industry and the surprising degree of its expansion.

The American farmer is an important factor in taking care of this tremendous output. The ratio of increase of cars in the agricultural states as compared with 1915 ranges as high as 250 per cent. That is in

Oklahoma. But other farming communities make nearly as good showing. In California, which sometimes is termed "the autoists' paradise," there is now a car for every ten persons, which indicates that the auto has become almost a household necessity. The number of licenses issued in Oregon last year was about 35,000, but as some of these were applied to commercial cars the number of pleasure cars was somewhat smaller. It is predicted, however, that licenses issued this year will exceed 42,000, which easily will mean a car for every eighteen persons in the state.

The mournful cadence of the dire prediction of those timid souls who saw naught but financial and social disaster in the national investiture on the part of the automobile has virtually died away. Its good points so completely overshadow any harmful tendencies that popular judgment has accorded it warm endorsement.—Dallas Observer.

THE VOTER'S GUFF

The Courier is unable to discover what this everlasting harping-on about a business that is none of his business is buying C. C. Chapman, the erudite editor of the Oregon Voter. From the Voter's last issue we gain the alarming information that the abject failure of Clackamas county's corporation-less paving is the reason for Oregon City's decision not to buy or erect a municipal paving plant. That is characteristic of Mr. Chapman, for he is frequently called upon to deny some hasty statement based upon hastily accepted misinformation. Mr. Chapman says:

"Another brand of paving is being exploited in Oregon City. It is said to be a patented process of applying the penetration method. It was another way of using the penetration method that resulted in the costly failures on the Milwaukie-Sellwood road. If Oregon City will experiment with this new patented process it will be doing its customary service for the state in demonstrating how long each type can endure."

The Oregon City council seems to be profiting by Clackamas experience, for it declined to purchase a municipal paving plant."

It is said that Mr. Chapman is so engrossed in the affairs of his publication that he cannot find time to search for truth.

As a matter of facts, Oregon City would immediately put in a paving plant similar to that maintained by the county if it had the money. It has not given up the idea of a corporation-less plant, but would like to be sure that its treasury will stand the pressure. If the city could employ some of the material owned by the water board its paving problem would be solved. Denied the use of that material it would have to build an entirely new plant at a cost greater than the council seems to care to undertake at this time. Mr. Chapman's opinions and biased ideas as to the worth of Clackamas county paving are guff—pure guff. Our paving is as good as any Portland concern can show for two and three times the price.

SMALL BUT GOOD

The army of the United States is not what it should be in point of numbers, but what there is of it is the best in the world. We take for this statement the opinions of military authorities from all branches of service in practically all countries. Many of the foremost officers in the armies of other nations have inspected at some time or other the mobilized strength of the forces of this country. When General Pershing's army came out of Mexico recently a foreign military attaché was at the border as the tanned and hardened troops marched over the international line. The officer had seen Kitchener train a million Britons for the present war, had seen Japan's armies in the death struggle with Russia in the Russo-Jap war, and had seen the German boys in action in the trenches and European battle fields. What he said of the Pershing forces is interesting:

"Without doubt it is the finest fighting machine in the world. On this globe there is no army of its size to compare with this little army of Americans. They are equipped to perfection. Not even a buckle of the mules' harness is lacking. And with it is the spirit of the American soldier. What it is I cannot say, but it is there. In the swing of their bodies and the set of their shoulders I could see it."

These words from a foreign authority accompanied the beat of the well-shod feet of 12,000 men, seasoned from service on the deserts of northern Mexico, sounded on the border line as they marched to home stations on this side of the Rio Grande. The worth of the statement is not in its words, but in the fact that there are other millions of men and young men of the same hardy type, with the same broad shoulders and deep chests, the same swing, the same determined glint in their eyes, who are ready at a moment's notice to shoulder the cares of the nation and advance upon any enemy.

Obituaries

F. E. McCugin

F. E. McCugin, a lifelong resident of Sandy, died at Banning, Cal., Sunday, after an illness of three years. He had been in California for his health since November. Mr. McCugin was 46 years old and single. He was a son of Henry McCugin, who died at Sandy February 6. The body will be brought to Sandy for burial.

Mrs. T. J. Kirk

Mrs. T. J. Kirk, aged 70 years, died at her home at Highland early Friday morning. Mrs. Kirk was a Clackamas county pioneer, having located here with her family in 1852.

25c Per Month is the Average Cost of Operating a Mitchell Water System

Don't Envy the City Man's Home Make Him Envy Yours!

The city man envies the ruralite for his pure air, his elbow room and his broad gauge life in general but he pities him for one thing—His Water Supply. A few years ago and this city was well founded, but now the shoe is on the other foot.

THE Mitchell Water System

The MITCHELL SYSTEM enables you

To use as MUCH water as you wish WHEN YOU WISH, to have as MANY faucets as you want WHERE YOU want them at no extra cost; to regulate your own pressure—as MUCH or as LITTLE as you wish; to use your water for gardening—irrigating—sprinkling or for whatever other purpose you may desire. That's why a MITCHELL WATER SYSTEM gives you the best of the City Man.

The Mitchell Water System supplies you with unlimited dependable supply of pure cool water at no more cost (usually not as much) per month than is paid by the average city man for his restricted supply. This is not so of other water systems, which often are a source of a great deal more trouble than satisfaction owing to improper construction or poor installation. We have installed hundreds of Mitchell Systems in all parts of the Northwest—they are giving satisfaction to every buyer. We, if given the opportunity, will gladly give you the benefit of our six years' experience in the pneumatic water supply. We will plan for your home a Mitchell System that will exactly fit your requirements—that will give you service which will please you now and continue to do so for years and years—that's our policy—COMPLETE AND PERMANENT SATISFACTION TO EVERY BUYER—and we have the goods that uphold every claim we make for them. Write us today for our free book on country and suburban water supply systems. Ask for book.

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MR. REYNOLDS of Clackamas, Oregon, has a MITCHELL SYSTEM.



W. J. WILSON & CO., Oregon City Agent

She is survived by nine children, 16 grandchildren, two brothers and one sister, many of whom are prominent in the life of the county today. Mrs. Kirk was the aunt of County Clerk Iva Harrington and Mrs. D. E. Frost, wife of Constable Frost, is a daughter. Funeral services were held on Sunday from the family home and interment was made in Highland cemetery.

Those who survive Mrs. Kirk are: Olive Fellows of Highland; Mrs. D. E. Frost of Oregon City; Frank Kirk of Highland; Charles Kirk of Oregon City; George Kirk of California; Eugene Kirk of Highland; Sylvester Kirk of Rainier, Oregon; Edwin Kirk of Grays River, Wash.; Mrs. Helen Baker of Lents, Oregon. She also leaves two brothers, J. N. Harrington of Sellwood; Edwin Harrington of Gladstone; a sister, Mrs. Emily Hamilton of Portland, and 16 grandchildren.

Contributed: No one, I think, could have intimately known Mrs. Kirk without yielding to her character as a woman, wife, mother, friend and neighbor, their esteem. Her religion was of this world. She recognized no authority but that of reason. Her rational belief sustained her in health and during her long and painful illness, with the thought of death before her at no distant period. She was calm and resigned. In the last solemn moments of her life, when looking, as it were, into her own grave, she was still tranquil and composed. She had no fears, no tremblings lest she should have missed the right path, but sustained by an approving conscience she left a last farewell to her family and went peacefully and undismayed into the great departed. Death had no terrors for her; it brought regrets at the thought of leaving those she held dearest on earth, but the consciousness of a blameless life was amply sufficient for her in the last sad hours of life.

The departed, the departed, They visit us in dreams, And they glide above our memories, Like shadows over streams, But were the cheerful lights of home In constant lustre burn, The departed, the departed, Can never more return.

LINCOLN EULOGIZED

Congregational Church Has Interesting Memorial Service

At the Congregational church on Sunday evening last the Rev. J. W. MacCallum directed his sermon as a eulogy to Abraham Lincoln, taking a text from Hebrews 11, 4: "He, being dead, yet speaketh." The choir under Dr. Roy A. Prudden and the orchestra under Prof. Gustave Flechner rendered special music. Mr. MacCallum said of Lincoln:

"His homely, suggestive phrase, 'God must have loved the common

There are thousands of children who are bright but frail—not sick but underdeveloped—they play with their food—they catch colds easily and do not thrive—they only need the pure, rich liquid-food in

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people better than anybody else, or he would not have made so many of them," marked him from the start as one of them and made them his worshippers. The radiance from his virtues makes his memory shed glory on all ages. A dictator in desperate times, he left no taint of crime. Administrator of law, mercy glorified his faultless decisions. Lifted by a mighty people's will to the supreme summit of power, he bowed at the foot of the cross and became a Christian.

"He said that the name of Washington was the greatest in history. Long since all nations have declared his own to be the mightiest on earth—purest and mightiest in the cause of civil liberty, in moral reform. On his name a eulogy is expected. It cannot be done; to add brightness to the sun or glory to the name of Lincoln is alike impossible. Let none attempt it. In solemn, holy awe I pronounce the name, and in naked, deathless splendor leave it shining on."

Scandinavian Day at The State Fair There will be a Scandinavian day at the state fair this year, as there

has been the two previous years. Dr. John O. Hall has been named by the state fair board as director for the day. Dr. Hall is of the Willamette university faculty, is of Norwegian descent and is well known by the Scandinavian people throughout the state. The name was presented to the board by the Rev. John Ovall, who originated the idea of Scandinavian day at the fair and who had charge of that day for two successful years and is active in perpetuating the idea. Rev. Mr. Ovall is of Swedish descent, but thought it advisable to suggest the name of a man of Norwegian descent so that the different factors among the Scandinavian people would be represented. The day will be on Friday of the fair week.

Scandinavian Service Here There will be Scandinavian service in the Methodist church, Oregon City, on Sunday at 3 o'clock. Rev. John Ovall will preach. Good songs and music will be rendered, and an invitation is extended to all Scandinavians.

R. L. Holman, Leading Undertaker, Fifth and Main St.; Telephones: Pacific 415-J; Home B-18.

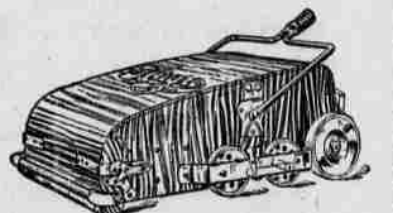
Concord Builds Walk Among the recent improvements in the Concord district is 1945 lineal feet of board walk from Railroad avenue to Risley, avenue connecting with Oreille avenue.

Courier and Daily Journal—\$4.75.

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Oregon City's Busy Store

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